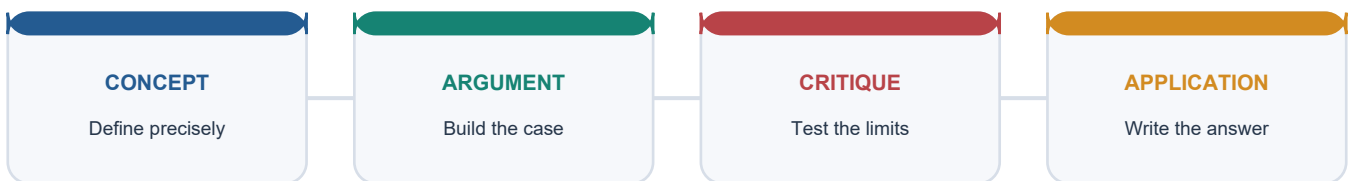


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Solved Practice Workbook	4
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	4
RAPID REVISION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What	4
RAPID REVISION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World	4
RAPID REVISION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)	4
RAPID REVISION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)	5
RAPID REVISION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions	5
RAPID REVISION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)	5
RAPID REVISION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)	5
RAPID REVISION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning	6
RAPID REVISION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction	6
RAPID REVISION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7	6
ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 40 QUESTIONS	16
Supplemental hard MCQs 41-48	25
REVIEW-PROMOTED ANALYTIC-TRIO MCQS	27
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	29
EXAM APPLICATION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What	29
EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World	29
EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)	30
EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)	30
EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions	30
EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)	31
EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)	31
EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning	31

EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction	32
EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7	32
Workbook Source Audit	32
Practice Design	33
SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 14 VERIFIED CLAUSE-OWNED QUESTIONS	33
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	43
Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades	44

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

RAPID REVISION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What

Rapid recall

- Context: revolt against **Absolute/Hegelian-Bradleyan Idealism**; Moore and Russell were idealists first.
- Shared method: **logical analysis of language/propositions**; reveal **logical** form behind **grammatical** form.
- Owners: Moore = commonsense + refutation of idealism; Russell = atomism, constructions, incomplete symbols, descriptions; early Wittgenstein = picture theory + saying/showing.
- **Logical Atomism** is co-owned: Russell (1918) *and* the *Tractatus*, and they differ.
- **Trap**: do not blur the three, and do not claim the 2018 Berkeley question - it is Empiricism-owned.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 1-3; PYQ cross-link 2018 Q3(a) [Empiricism].

RAPID REVISION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World

Rapid recall

- Texts: *A Defence of Common Sense* (1925, the truisms/list paper); *Proof of an External World* (1939, the hands paper) - do not merge them.
- Truisms are **known with certainty**; **knowing** a proposition $\neq$ **analysing** it; failure of analysis never cancels knowledge.
- Proof: right hand first, then left; three conditions - premiss **different** from conclusion, premiss **known**, conclusion **follows**.
- Method = **burden reversal**: no sceptical premiss is more certain than "here is a hand."
- **Trap**: Moore does not *prove realism* or *refute* the sceptic; he shows the sceptic's argument cannot be sound.
- Deepest reply = **Wittgenstein's hinge** diagnosis (*On Certainty*, Later Wittgenstein - comparison only).
- **Practice link**: MCQs 4-7; PYQs 2021 Q3(a), 2024 Q1(c), 2019 Q3(c).

RAPID REVISION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)

Rapid recall

- Text: *The Refutation of Idealism*, 1903 (*Mind*); do not confuse with *Principia Ethica* (same year).
- Target: **esse est percipi** (Berkeley); general idealism that reality is mind-dependent.
- Core move: in every sensation distinguish the **act** of awareness (constant) from the **object** (variable: blue vs green).
- **Diaphanous/transparency**: consciousness is "seen through," so the act is overlooked and fused with the object - the idealist's error.
- Result: object $\neq$ act, so objects can exist unperceived; *esse* $\neq$ *percipi*.
- **Limits/trap**: refutes one argument for idealism, not realism directly; does **not** touch Hegel; diaphanous thesis is the weak point; sense-datum legacy collapses under Sellars.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 8-10; PYQs 2025 Q3(c), 2020 Q2(b).

RAPID REVISION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)

Rapid recall

- Text: *The Philosophy of Logical Atomism* (lectures 1918); Russell's own preface credits Wittgenstein.
- World = **atomic facts**; ideal language = **atomic propositions** (proper name(s) + predicate) mirroring them.
- **Molecular** propositions are **truth-functions** of atomic ones; connectives name nothing.
- **Isomorphism**: names $\leftrightarrow$ objects; arrangement of names $\leftrightarrow$ arrangement of objects.
- **Logical, not physical** atoms = last residue of **analysis**, marking logical independence, not size.
- Russell's atoms = sense-data + universals (epistemic); *Tractatus* atoms = objects (logical, unexemplified).
- **Trap**: "atomic fact" is not a microscopic fact; do not equate Russell's and Wittgenstein's atomism.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 11-13; PYQs 2020 Q2(c), 2022 Q1(b).

RAPID REVISION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions

Rapid recall

- Text: *On Denoting* (1905, *Mind*); descriptions restated in *Principia Mathematica*.
- **Incomplete symbol** = no meaning in isolation; contributes only in context; disappears on analysis.
- Analysis of "the F is G": **existence + uniqueness + predication** - $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$.
- Empty description $\Rightarrow$ existence clause false $\Rightarrow$ sentence **FALSE** (not meaningless, no Meinongian object).
- Three puzzles solved: **negative existentials**, **excluded middle (via scope)**, **identity/substitutivity**.
- **Primary vs secondary occurrence** = wide vs narrow scope of negation.
- Grammatical form $\neq$ **logical form** - the founding principle of analysis.
- **Trap**: "false, not meaningless"; Strawson's **presupposition** is a rival, not a refutation of the logic.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 14-18; PYQs 2025 Q1(d), 2023 Q4(b), 2024 Q3(a).

RAPID REVISION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)

Rapid recall

- Text: *Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by Description* (1911); *The Problems of Philosophy* (1912).
- **Acquaintance** = direct, inference-free presentation: sense-data, memory, introspection, **universals**.
- **Description** = indirect, "the so-and-so," via a true proposition; **extends knowledge beyond the given**.
- **Principle of Acquaintance**: every understood proposition is composed wholly of constituents we are acquainted with.
- **Bismarck series**: Bismarck $\rightarrow$ someone who met him $\rightarrow$ we (purely by description) = the "how related" answer.
- **Logically proper name** ("this/that") guaranteed a referent; **ordinary names are disguised descriptions**.
- **Trap**: the secure base ("this/that" for present sense-data) is thin/near-solipsistic - the objection to note.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 19-21; no owned PYQ - underpins 2018 Q4(c) and 2023 Q4(b).

RAPID REVISION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)

Rapid recall

- Texts: *Our Knowledge of the External World* (1914); *The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics* (1914); *Mysticism and Logic*.
- **Supreme maxim**: substitute **constructions out of known entities** for **inferences to unknown entities**.
- Material object = **logical construction** = orderly **system of sense-data**, not an inferred hidden thing.
- Constructions are voiced by **incomplete symbols** - same device as descriptions (unit 5); names vanish on analysis.

- Motive = **ontological economy / Occam's razor**; continuity with **atomism** (nothing posited above the atoms).
- **Trap**: private-sense-data base => **solipsism/other-minds** worry; some inferences remain => a **regulative ideal**.
- Sellars' "Myth of the Given" later erodes the sense-datum foundation.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 22-23; PYQs 2018 Q4(c), 2024 Q3(a).

RAPID REVISION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning

Rapid recall

- Text: *Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus* (German *Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung* 1921; Ogden Eng. tr. 1922; Pears-McGuinness 1961). Cite the **decimal numbering** (1, 1.1, 2.1...).
- **1.1** "The world is the totality of **facts, not of things**." Facts = states of affairs = **objects** in combination.
- **Elementary proposition** = configuration of **names** picturing a **state of affairs**.
- **Picture theory**: a proposition is a **picture**; names <-> objects; **arrangement** <-> **arrangement**.
- **Pictorial form** (depicts at all) vs **logical form** (shared by every picture and reality) vs **projective/mapping** relation.
- Sense = capacity to be **true or false** (bipolarity implicit); a proposition is **not** a mental image (logical, not psychological).
- **Trap**: keep "objects" (unexemplified simples) distinct from Russell's sense-data; form is **shown**, not said.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 24-27; PYQ 2022 Q3(c).

RAPID REVISION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction

Rapid recall

- **Bipolarity**: a genuine proposition must be **able to be true and able to be false**; saying = ruling out.
- **Logical space** (*logischer Raum*): the totality of possibilities; a proposition fixes one place and excludes the rest.
- **General form of the proposition** (prop 6): [**p-bar, xi-bar, N(xi-bar)**] - every proposition = truth-operations (joint negation **N**) on **elementary propositions**.
- All connectives reduce to **N**; connectives name nothing; every proposition is a **truth-function** of elementary ones.
- **sinnlos** (senseless, well-formed, empty): **tautology, contradiction, logic. unsinnig** (nonsense, ill-formed): pseudo-metaphysics.
- **Trap**: tautology/contradiction are **sinnlos**, not false and not *unsinnig*; keep the two German terms apart.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 28-30; feeds PYQ 2021 Q4(c).

RAPID REVISION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7

Rapid recall

- **Saying** = senseful factual propositions (picturable, bipolar). **Showing** = logical form, ethics, aesthetics, the self, the **mystical** - displayed, not stated.
- **Ethics/aesthetics are transcendental**; "no ethical propositions." **Mystical**: not *how* but *that* the world is.
- **Self** = a **limit** of the world (5.6 "limits of my language = limits of my world"), not an object in it.
- **Ladder (6.54)**: the *Tractatus*'s own sentences are **unsinnig**; climb, see aright, **throw the ladder away**.
- **Proposition 7**: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent."
- **Self-referential paradox**: nonsense that still instructs - **resolute** (therapeutic nonsense) vs **standard** (illuminating nonsense) readings.
- **Trap**: keep this *early* Wittgenstein; the *Tractatus*->Investigations shift is only a **boundary**, not this answer.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 31-32; PYQs 2018 Q3(c), 2021 Q4(c).

CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)

The examiner apparatus below is reproduced verbatim from the canonical Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein.md (headings demoted, navigation links stripped). It is preserved intact so that no canonical depth - inter-thinker debates, criticisms and replies, traps, keyword bank, the restored 2018/2020 dossier, the corpus depth delta, PYQ routing, answer architecture, directive rules, verdict bank, provenance discipline and sources - is lost in the layered reorganisation.

Inter-Thinker and Inter-School Debates

Axis	Moore	Russell	Early Wittgenstein
Target	Idealism (<i>esse est percipi</i>)	Metaphysical excess / ontological inflation	Limits of meaningful language
Core tool	Commonsense + act/object distinction	Logical analysis (theory of descriptions)	Picture theory of propositions
Ontology	Realism - mind-independent objects	Logical atoms (sense-data + universals); constructions	Facts (states of affairs), not things; objects unspecified
Metaphysics	Analyse it, don't abolish it	Trim by constructions; tolerate what survives analysis	Most is <i>unsinnig</i> - silence; only what can be pictured is sayable
Private mental life	Real; distinct from objects	Sense-data as epistemic base	Not addressed (but language presupposes logical form, not private experience)
Legacy	Oxford ordinary-language philosophy	Logical positivism; Quine	Logical positivism (initially); then repudiated by his <i>own</i> later self

Russell's Logical Atomism vs Wittgenstein's Tractatus Atomism

	Russell	Wittgenstein
What are the "atoms"?	Sense-data, universals - identifiable by acquaintance	"Objects" - logical simples whose nature is unspecified; known only via their combinatorial possibilities
Epistemological ground	Foundationalist: knowledge by acquaintance vs description	Not epistemological - purely logical: what <i>must</i> be the case for propositions to have determinate sense
Logical independence of atoms	Acknowledged, somewhat loosely	Strictly insisted upon - elementary propositions are logically independent
Published expression	"The Philosophy of Logical Atomism" lectures (1918) - acknowledges Wittgenstein's influence	<i>Tractatus</i> (written 1918, pub. 1921)

Criticisms and Replies

8.1 Criticisms of Moore

Objection	Assessment
"Here is one hand" begs the question against the sceptic - the sceptic <i>denies</i> the premise	ANALYSIS: Moore's defenders (e.g. Pryor) argue he shifts the dialectical burden: the sceptic must explain why we should trust abstruse philosophical premises over immediate perceptual knowledge
The "paradox of analysis" shows conceptual analysis may be uninformative	ANALYSIS: Yes, but Moore does not claim analysis is easy - only that <i>knowledge</i> of truisms does not wait on analysis
Moore's refutation targets Berkeley-style idealism; does not touch Absolute Idealism (Hegel)	FACT: Correct - the act-object distinction refutes <i>esse est percipi</i> , not "the Real is the Rational"

8.2 Criticisms of Russell

Objection	Assessment
Strawson ("On Referring", 1950): "The present King of France is bald" is not false but involves a failed <i>presupposition</i> ; the question of truth/falsehood does not arise	FACT: A genuine rival analysis; see Quine-Strawson §3.4
What are "logically proper names" that refer directly to simples? Russell admits only "this" and "that" in moments of sense-experience qualify - deeply restrictive	FACT: Yes; Russell was aware this shrinks the realm of genuine names drastically
Quine: the analytic-synthetic distinction on which "meaning in isolation" rests is itself untenable	ANALYSIS: Quine's holism undermines the isolation criterion; but the <i>logical</i> move of the theory of descriptions (contextual definition) survives within a holistic framework

8.3 Criticisms of the Tractatus

Objection	Assessment
The picture theory cannot account for ethical, aesthetic, or religious language - it consigns them to silence	FACT: This is deliberate demarcation; it is one pressure among several on the later transition
Self-refutation: the <i>Tractatus</i> tries to <i>say</i> what (by its own lights) can only be <i>shown</i> - so its own propositions are nonsensical	FACT: Wittgenstein acknowledges this (the ladder metaphor); 6.54 makes the self-application deliberate, while its success remains disputed
No examples of genuine elementary propositions are ever given	FACT: The text gives no uncontested examples; this remains a lacuna - we never learn what "objects" are
Later Wittgenstein: the assumption of one logical form behind all language is wrong - there are indefinitely many language-games with no common essence	FACT: See Later Wittgenstein

Common UPSC Traps

Trap	Discrimination
"Russell's logical atomism = Wittgenstein's logical atomism"	No. Russell's 1918 atoms involve acquainted particulars plus qualities/relations; Wittgenstein's objects are logical simples unspecified in nature.
"Incomplete symbols are meaningless"	No. They have no meaning <i>in isolation</i> ; they contribute systematically to the meaning of whole sentences.
"The theory of descriptions shows the King-of-France sentence is meaningless"	No - it shows the sentence is false . Meaninglessness is what it <i>avoids</i> .
"Moore <i>proves</i> realism"	Not quite - he shows the idealist's <i>argument</i> fails; he shifts the burden of proof. He does not construct a positive proof of the existence of matter beyond commonsense.
" <i>Sinnlos</i> (senseless) = <i>unsinnig</i> (nonsensical)"	No. Tautologies are <i>sinnlos</i> (empty but well-formed); metaphysical pseudo-propositions are <i>unsinnig</i> (violations of sense).
"The <i>Tractatus</i> rejects ethics and religion as false"	No - it says they lie <i>beyond</i> the sayable; they <i>show</i> themselves. "Silence" is demarcation, not dismissal.
"Saying and showing" = the easy/hard problem	No. It is about <i>logical expressibility</i> : propositions can SAY facts; the logical form that makes this possible can only SHOW itself in propositions.
"Logical constructions = fictions"	No. We can say true things about a nation or a table; they are not <i>additional ontological posits</i> but are analysable in terms of simpler entities.

Keyword and Statement Bank

#	Item	Use
1	FACT: Moore: "Here is one hand, and here is another."	Defence of Commonsense / Proof of External World
2	FACT: Moore: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness... is different from either."	Refutation of Idealism (2025 Q3(c))
3	FACT: Russell: "Wherever possible, logical constructions are to be substituted for inferred entities."	Logical Constructions
4	FACT: Russell: A definite description is an "incomplete symbol" - no meaning in isolation	Theory of Descriptions
5	FACT: Wittgenstein: "The world is the totality of facts, not of things."	Ontology of the <i>Tractatus</i>
6	FACT: Wittgenstein: "A proposition is a picture of reality."	Picture Theory
7	FACT: Wittgenstein: "What can be shown, cannot be said."	Say/Show distinction
8	FACT: Wittgenstein: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent."	Closing proposition 7
9	ANALYSIS: "Grammatical form ≠ logical form"	Shared insight of Russell and Wittgenstein - engine of analytic method
10	ANALYSIS: Russell's three puzzles: identity, excluded middle, negative existentials	Why the theory of descriptions matters

Restored 2018/2020 Doctrine Dossier

Moore's "Blue exists" argument

- FACT: **Statement:** consciousness of blue and blue are distinguishable; idealism commits an act-object error when it treats the object as a constituent identical with awareness.
- FACT: **Argument:** attention can discriminate the transparent act of awareness from the quality presented; if "blue exists" meant "blue and consciousness exist", the two propositions would have the same content, which Moore denies.
- CAUTION: **Objection -> reply:** introspective discriminability may not establish mind-independent existence. Moore's point is narrower but damaging: esse cannot simply be defined as percipi.

Russell: descriptions and atomic facts

- FACT: Definite descriptions are incomplete symbols eliminated by contextual analysis; the analysis reveals quantified logical form without naming a mysterious object.
- FACT: Logical atomism seeks atomic facts as the last logical residues required for true atomic propositions. "Atomic" therefore marks logical independence/structure, not microscopic physical size.
- ANALYSIS: The description theory supports atomism by separating grammatical subjects from genuine logical constituents, but it does not by itself prove that reality is exhaustively atomic.

Saying and showing

- FACT: Propositions say how facts stand; logical form cannot be represented as another fact without regress and is shown in meaningful symbolism. The limit is justificatory only if the distinction itself is not illicitly stated as a theory.

Corpus-Driven Depth Delta (2018-2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 14 of 112 parts, joint-highest, with at least one part in every year.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers add saying/showing as a response to philosophy's limits, descriptions as a route to logical atomism, Moore's "Blue exists" argument and Russell's logical-not physical-atomic facts.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Keep the three programmes distinct: Moore exposes the act/object confusion, Russell analyses surface grammar, and early Wittgenstein separates what propositions say from logical

form shown.

PYQ Routing (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 14 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q3(c)	15 marks	How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.
2018	Q4(c)	15 marks	How is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons for your answer.
2019	Q3(c)	15 marks	Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?
2020	Q2(b)	15 marks	Critically discuss the following statement by Moore: "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake."
2020	Q2(c)	15 marks	"The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of the above statement.
2021	Q3(a)	20 marks	What are the main arguments put forward by Moore in his paper "A Defence of Common Sense" to prove that there are possible propositions about the world that are known to be true with certainty? Do you think Moore's arguments provide a sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic against the possibility of knowledge? Give reasons in support of your answer.
2021	Q4(c)	15 marks	What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement - "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.
2022	Q1(b)	10 marks	What is Bertrand Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it ultimately end in establishing atomic theory of meaning? Discuss.
2022	Q3(c)	15 marks	Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.
2023	Q4(b)	15 marks	Why according to Russell is the proposition - "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.
2024	Q1(c)	10 marks	What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms, knowledge of which is a matter of common sense? Critically discuss.
2024	Q3(a)	20 marks	Explain Russell's notion of incomplete symbols. Also explain how this notion leads to the doctrine of logical atomism.
2025	Q1(d)	10 marks	"The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions.
2025	Q3(c)	15 marks	"Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement.

See the Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 marks)

10-mark: "The golden mountain is very high - discuss via Russell's theory of descriptions." (2025)

Problem : The sentence seems to be ABOUT a non-existent entity. Does it commit us to the existence of golden mountains? Is it meaningless?

Analysis: "The golden mountain" is an INCOMPLETE SYMBOL - no meaning in isolation.

Analysed: "There exists exactly one thing that is a golden mountain, and it is very high." - $\text{Ex}[\text{Gx} \ \& \ \text{Ay}(\text{Gy} \rightarrow \text{y}=\text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Hx}]$.

Result : The existence clause is false -> the whole statement is FALSE, not meaningless, and no golden mountain need "subsist" (contra Meinong).

Point : Grammatical form $\neq$ logical form; descriptions eliminate ontological inflation.

15-mark: Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to blue/green/consciousness. (2025)

Frame : Idealist claim - esse est percipi. To be = to be perceived.
Moore : In every sensation distinguish (1) the ACT of awareness (consciousness) and (2) the OBJECT of awareness (blue, green).
Quote : "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."
Key move: Consciousness is DIAPHANOUS/transparent - we "see through" it to the object; this tempts us to conflate act and object. But they are distinct.
Result : Object ≠ act, so esse cannot be defined as percipi; unperceived mind-independence still requires further argument.
Assess : Moore refutes one argument FOR idealism (Berkeley's equation) but does not directly address Absolute Idealism (Hegel) or provide a full theory of perception. Still, the act-object distinction became foundational for analytic philosophy.

20-mark: Russell's incomplete symbols -> logical atomism. (2024)

Frame : Russell's analytic method - reveal logical form behind grammatical form.
Body-A : Incomplete symbols - have no meaning in isolation; disappear on analysis.
Theory of Descriptions: "The present King of France is bald" -> $\exists x[Kx \ \& \ Ay(Ky \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Bx]$.
Three puzzles solved: negative existentials, excluded middle, substitutivity.
Body-B : Logical Constructions - "substitute constructions for inferences."
Physical objects, nations, numbers -> constructions out of known entities (sense-data, classes).
Body-C : Logical Atomism - the world mirrors the ideal logical language:
atomic facts $\leftrightarrow$ atomic propositions; molecular = truth-functions of atomic.
The method seeks final logical residues, but description theory does not prove that analysis terminates.
Description theory removes pseudo-constituents and supports atomist analysis without proving its final ontology.
Assess : Strengths - Occam's razor applied brilliantly; dissolves pseudo-problems.
Weaknesses - what are the genuine "atoms"? Sense-data? Russell never fully identifies them.
Strawson's rival account of descriptions (presupposition, not assertion of existence).
Quine's holism questions whether meaning "in isolation" is coherent.
Close : Incomplete symbols are the scalpel of analytic philosophy; logical atomism is the metaphysics toward which the scalpel cuts.

Directive Decoder

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Discuss/Explain with reference to the theory of descriptions (2025 Q1d, 2024, 2023)	the symbolic analysis , not a paraphrase	Write the three conjuncts (existence, uniqueness, predication) in logical notation, then the scope distinction, then the puzzle solved.	Explaining "the golden mountain" in words with no formalisation.
Elucidate (quotation-led, e.g. Moore's "Blue exists")	locate the sentence in the paper's argument	Name the paper and year, the target (idealism / <i>esse est percipi</i>), the distinction it turns on (act vs object).	Free-floating gloss.
Critically examine the picture theory	assessment dominates	Reconstruct via bipolarity + logical space + general form, then the colour-exclusion breakdown, then a ruling.	Describing "propositions picture facts" and adding one criticism.
What is meant by saying/showing? (2021 Q4c)	show that the distinction is forced , not stipulated	Derive it: logical form is presupposed by all depiction, hence not depictable; then the ladder and 7.	Listing sayable and showable items.
Examine Moore's defence of common sense	the structure of the reversal of burden	Truisms -> knowing vs analysing -> the certainty-comparison argument -> the <i>On Certainty</i> diagnosis.	"Moore held up his hands."
Distinguish / Compare (Russell's atomism vs <i>Tractatus</i> atomism)	fix a criterion first	Axis: are the simples epistemic (Russell's sense-data) or logical posits (Wittgenstein's objects, never exemplified)?	Two parallel descriptions.
Comment on "incomplete symbol"	a definition + a test , then a consequence	Definition: no meaning in isolation, meaning only in context of a whole sentence. Test: does the phrase disappear on analysis? Consequence: ontological economy.	Repeating "incomplete symbol" without the contextual-definition criterion.
Assess the significance of	say what changed in philosophy	Grammatical form ≠ logical form -> the whole programme of analysis; Moore's method -> ordinary language philosophy.	Praise without content.

Graded Verdict Bank

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Defence of common sense	Moore does not refute scepticism; he changes what needs defending, by insisting that no sceptical premiss is more certain than "here is a hand."	...The distinction between <i>knowing</i> a proposition and <i>analysing</i> it is the durable contribution: it shows that philosophical difficulty about analysis never by itself impugns ordinary knowledge.	Moore's method is a <i>procedure for weighing certainties</i> , and as such it is unanswerable but also unilluminating - it tells the sceptic he is wrong without saying why. Later <i>On Certainty</i> reframes these as framework/hinge certainties; that positive doctrine remains cross-owned.
Refutation of Idealism	Moore's refutation turns wholly on the act/object distinction: sensation has a content that is <i>not</i> the sensing of it.	...The "diaphanous" claim (consciousness is transparent, easily overlooked) is both the argument's engine and its weak point - if awareness is that elusive, the alleged distinction is asserted rather than exhibited.	Moore's paper is historically decisive and philosophically incomplete: it broke the hold of British Idealism by refusing <i>esse est percipi</i> rather than by disproving it, and it bequeathed the sense-datum theory whose collapse (Sellars) removed its own foundation. The revolt succeeded; the positive doctrine did not.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Theory of descriptions	Descriptions is not a theory of meaning but a method of elimination : it removes an apparent constituent by rewriting the sentence.	...Its three payoffs are exact - the law of excluded middle is preserved by the scope distinction, negative existentials become intelligible, and identity puzzles dissolve - and each is a genuine solution, not a redescription.	Strawson's objection ("On Referring," 1950) that Russell confuses <i>asserting</i> existence with <i>presupposing</i> it identifies a real feature of ordinary use but does not damage the logical analysis, which was never offered as a description of conversation. The theory therefore survives as logic and fails as semantics of natural language - and Russell's own further claim, that ordinary names are disguised descriptions, is refuted by Kripke. Separate these three claims and the answer writes itself.
Acquaintance vs description	The distinction exists to pay an epistemological debt: how we speak of what we have never met.	...The Principle of Acquaintance is the premiss and the Theory of Descriptions is the device that saves it - they are one doctrine, not two.	The logical machinery has proved permanent; the epistemology it was built to serve - sense-data as bedrock, names as disguised descriptions - has not survived Sellars's attack on the Given and Kripke's on the description theory of names. That asymmetry is the most instructive fact about Russell: his instruments outlived his purposes.
Logical atomism	Atomism is the ontology that logical analysis <i>requires</i> : if analysis terminates, it terminates in simples.	...Russell's atoms are epistemic (sense-data, universals), Wittgenstein's are logical posits never exemplified - a difference that makes Russell's version empirically vulnerable and Wittgenstein's unfalsifiable.	Logical atomism is best read as a conditional : <i>if</i> language is fully analysable into truth-functions of independent elementary propositions, <i>then</i> the world has the structure of independent atomic facts. The antecedent fails - colour exclusion breaks independence, belief-contexts break truth-functionality - so the ontology lapses while the method of analysis survives. Wittgenstein drew this conclusion first, and against himself.
Logical constructions	"Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities" is Occam's razor turned into a working method.	...It succeeds for numbers and points; it strains for physical objects, since "possible sense-data" reintroduce unactualised entities the maxim was meant to avoid.	The maxim's real legacy is not its ontology but its <i>style</i> : it establishes reduction-by-contextual-definition as the characteristic technique of analytic philosophy, and it is the direct ancestor of Carnap's <i>Aufbau</i> and of Quine's ontological relativity. It failed as a programme and succeeded as a paradigm.
Picture theory	Sense is the possession of a logical place: a proposition depicts by sharing logical form with a possible situation.	...Bipolarity is the condition, logical space the field, and the general form $[\bar{p}, \xi, N(\xi)]$ the generating rule - three faces of one doctrine.	The picture theory is the most economical account of meaning ever constructed and faces pressure from its own stringent assumptions: the elementary base cannot be logically independent (colour exclusion), and not every proposition is truth-functional (belief). Wittgenstein's later work is therefore not a recantation but the systematic dismantling of two presuppositions he was the first to identify.
Saying vs showing	The distinction is not stipulated but forced: logical form is presupposed by all depiction, hence cannot itself be depicted.	...It makes the <i>Tractatus</i> self-consuming, which the ladder passage concedes rather than conceals; the book's own propositions are <i>unsinnig</i> by its own criterion.	Whether the self-application is a fatal contradiction or the book's deepest teaching is the standard-vs-resolute reading dispute (Anscombe/Hacker vs Diamond/Conant). The examiner-safe ruling: it is not an inconsistency Wittgenstein overlooked - 6.54 shows he saw it - so 6.54 makes self-application deliberate; standard and resolute readings still disagree, and later positive doctrine remains outside this owner.

Translation, Numbering and Provenance Discipline

Moore and Russell wrote in English. Wittgenstein did not. Different disciplines apply to each.

Moore and Russell - attribution and dating

Item	Correct provenance	Caution
"The Refutation of Idealism"	<i>Mind</i> , 1903	ANALYSIS: Same year as <i>Principia Ethica</i> ; do not conflate the two works.
"A Defence of Common Sense"	in <i>Contemporary British Philosophy</i> , 1925	The truisms/list paper.
"Proof of an External World"	British Academy lecture, 1939	The hands paper. ANALYSIS: These are three different papers with three different arguments; the commonest error in scripts is to merge 1925 and 1939.
The hands gesture	Moore's text specifies right hand first, then left	See §1.2. If unsure, write "holding up first one hand and then the other."
"On Denoting"	<i>Mind</i> , 1905	The theory of descriptions proper.
"Knowledge by Acquaintance and Knowledge by Description"	<i>PAS</i> , 1910-11 ; restated in <i>The Problems of Philosophy</i> , 1912 , Ch. 5	FACT: The Principle of Acquaintance is safe to quote verbatim from <i>Problems</i> .
"Philosophy of Logical Atomism"	lectures 1918 , delivered in London, published in <i>The Monist</i> 1918-19	ANALYSIS: Russell's own preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein; say so - it earns a mark and pre-empts the "who owns atomism" trap.
"Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities"	"Logical Atomism" (1924) / <i>Our Knowledge of the External World</i> (1914), where it is called the supreme maxim in scientific philosophising	FACT: Safe.
Strawson's reply	"On Referring," <i>Mind</i> , 1950	ANALYSIS: Not a refutation of the logic; a claim about presupposition in ordinary use.
Kripke's reply	<i>Naming and Necessity</i> , lectures 1970 , book 1980	ANALYSIS: Give the lecture date or the book date, not a merged one.

Wittgenstein - the Tractatus: numbering and translation

Item	Discipline
The text	Written 1918; published in German as <i>Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung</i> in <i>Annalen der Naturphilosophie</i> , 1921 ; the German-English parallel edition with the Latin title <i>Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus</i> appeared in 1922 . ANALYSIS: The Latin title was Moore's suggestion , not Wittgenstein's. Do not write "the <i>Tractatus</i> (1921)" without noting the edition, and never date the English text 1921.
Translations	Ogden (with Ramsey's assistance, 1922, checked by Wittgenstein himself) and Pears-McGuinness (1961). ANALYSIS: These differ at exactly the points most often quoted.
Proposition 7	Ogden: " Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent. " Pears-McGuinness: " What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence. " Name the translation whenever you quote 7 - both are correct, and presenting one as "the" wording is not.
Citation by decimal number, always FACT:	The numbering is Wittgenstein's own and is identical in every edition and translation - 1.1, 2.11, 2.223, 3.4, 4.0312, 4.06, 4.461, 4.5, 5, 5.51, 5.6, 6, 6.1251, 6.522, 6.54, 7. Decimal references are therefore the safest citation in the whole Western syllabus. Use them in place of quotation wherever you are unsure of wording.
What the decimals mean	1, 2, 3... are the seven principal propositions; n.1 is a comment on n; n.11 a comment on n.1. Saying this in one sentence demonstrates familiarity with the text's architecture. ANALYSIS: There is no proposition 7.1 - proposition 7 is deliberately uncommented and stands alone. Writing "7.1" is a giveaway error.
"The world is the totality of facts, not of things"	1.1 - FACT: both translations agree; safe verbatim.
"What can be shown, cannot be said"	4.1212 - FACT: safe.
The general form	6: [p̄ , ξ , N(ξ)] - FACT: reproduce the schema; it is notation, not translation. Explain N as joint negation ("none of these is true").
"Es verhält sich so und so"	4.5 - ANALYSIS: Ogden: "Such and such is the case"; Pears-McGuinness: "This is how things stand." Flag the rendering.
"Logical constants are not representatives" (<i>Grundgedanke</i>)	4.0312 - FACT: safe; call it Wittgenstein's "fundamental idea," which is his own word.
Colour exclusion	"Some Remarks on Logical Form," <i>PAS Supp.</i> 1929 - ANALYSIS: the only philosophical paper Wittgenstein published in his lifetime besides the <i>Tractatus</i> , and he quickly abandoned its proposed analysis; it is not his settled later solution.
"Picture theory"	ANALYSIS: Provenance : the label is the commentators'; Wittgenstein writes of <i>Bild</i> (picture/model) and <i>abbilden</i> (depict). Say "the doctrine usually called the picture theory."

WRONG: **Never write**: that the *Tractatus* was "published in English in 1921"; that Wittgenstein "said language is a picture of the world" without the *logical form* qualification; or that Russell invented logical atomism unaided - his own 1918 preface attributes it to Wittgenstein.

Sources

- G.E. Moore, "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903); "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925); "Proof of an External World" (1939).
- Bertrand Russell, "On Denoting" (1905); "The Philosophy of Logical Atomism" (1918); *Our Knowledge of the External World* (1914).
- Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus* (1921).
- A.J. Ayer, *Russell and Moore: The Analytical Heritage* (for the relationship between the three).
- Y. Masih, *A Critical History of Western Philosophy* (Moore, Russell, Wittgenstein chapters).
- Anthony Kenny, *A New History of Western Philosophy*, vol. 4 (analytic philosophy section).
- P.F. Strawson, "On Referring" (1950) - for the rival to Russell on descriptions.
- Nigel Warburton, *Philosophy: The Classics* (accessible overview).

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 40 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-32 are core coverage across all ten subtopics; Questions 33-40 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D ten times.

MCQ 1

The analytic revolt led by Moore and Russell was, in the first instance, a reaction against which movement?

- A. British Absolute (Hegelian-Bradleyan) Idealism B. The logical positivism of the Vienna Circle C. American pragmatism D. Cartesian rationalism

Correct answer: A - British Absolute (Hegelian-Bradleyan) Idealism

Explanation: Moore and Russell were idealists first and revolted against Bradley's Absolute Idealism; their shared weapon was the logical analysis of language.

MCQ 2

What method most clearly unites Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein?

- A. The transcendental deduction of the categories B. Logical analysis that reveals logical form behind grammatical form C. Dialectical synthesis of thesis and antithesis D. Phenomenological bracketing of the natural attitude

Correct answer: B - Logical analysis that reveals logical form behind grammatical form

Explanation: All three practise analysis of language or propositions to expose the logical form that surface grammar conceals.

MCQ 3

Which statement about the ownership of 'Logical Atomism' is correct?

- A. It is owned solely by the Tractatus B. It is owned solely by Russell C. It is co-owned by Russell (1918) and the Tractatus, though the two versions differ D. It is a doctrine internal to Moore's common-sense realism

Correct answer: C - It is co-owned by Russell (1918) and the Tractatus, though the two versions differ

Explanation: Atomism is co-owned: Russell's phase-specific atoms include acquainted particulars and universals, while the Tractatus's objects are logical simples left unexemplified.

MCQ 4

In 'A Defence of Common Sense', which distinction does Moore rely on to hold that a truism can be certain even if philosophers dispute its correct account?

- A. Sense versus reference B. Analytic versus synthetic C. Saying versus showing D. Knowing a proposition versus analysing it

Correct answer: D - Knowing a proposition versus analysing it

Explanation: Moore insists we know truisms with certainty even when we cannot give their correct analysis - the point behind the paradox of analysis.

MCQ 5

Moore's 'Proof of an External World' (1939) famously turns on which gesture?

- A. Holding up his hands: 'Here is one hand... and here is another' B. Declaring 'The world is all that is the case' C. Asserting 'esse est percipi' D. Concluding 'Whereof one cannot speak...'

Correct answer: A - Holding up his hands: 'Here is one hand... and here is another'

Explanation: Moore treats the existence of his two hands as a rigorous proof whose premises are known, differ from the conclusion, and entail it.

MCQ 6

How is Moore's reply to the sceptic best characterised?

- A. A transcendental argument from the conditions of possible experience B. A reversal of the burden of proof: the truism is more certain than any premise the sceptic can offer C. A verificationist criterion of meaning D. An appeal to a divine guarantee of our faculties

Correct answer: B - A reversal of the burden of proof: the truism is more certain than any premise the sceptic can offer

Explanation: Moore relocates certainty and shifts the burden; Wittgenstein's On Certainty later refines this with the 'hinge' diagnosis.

MCQ 7

The 'paradox of analysis' is the difficulty that:

A. every analysis is viciously circular B. analysis always destroys the meaning of the analysandum C. if an analysis is correct it seems trivial, yet if it is informative it seems incorrect D. no proposition can ever be analysed into atomic facts

Correct answer: C - if an analysis is correct it seems trivial, yet if it is informative it seems incorrect

Explanation: A correct analysis looks like a trivial identity, yet a genuinely useful analysis is informative - hence the puzzle Moore highlights.

MCQ 8

The specific target of Moore's 'Refutation of Idealism' is the thesis:

A. the Real is the Rational (Hegel) B. cogito ergo sum (Descartes) C. the world is the totality of facts (Wittgenstein) D. esse est percipi (Berkeley)

Correct answer: D - esse est percipi (Berkeley)

Explanation: Moore attacks the Berkeleyan identification of being with being-perceived; he explicitly does not touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism.

MCQ 9

The central distinction Moore draws inside every sensation is between:

A. the act of awareness (common to all sensations) and the object of awareness (which varies) B. sense and reference C. primary and secondary qualities D. analytic and synthetic judgments

Correct answer: A - the act of awareness (common to all sensations) and the object of awareness (which varies)

Explanation: Consciousness is the same in the sensation of blue and of green; the objects (blue, green) differ - so act and object are distinct.

MCQ 10

Moore describes consciousness as 'diaphanous' in order to say that:

A. consciousness is always coloured by its objects B. awareness is transparent, so we look through it and tend to overlook it C. consciousness cannot exist without a body D. the act and the object are ultimately identical

Correct answer: B - awareness is transparent, so we look through it and tend to overlook it

Explanation: Transparency explains why idealists overlook the act and fuse it with the object; it is also, notoriously, Moore's own weak point.

MCQ 11

When Russell insists his atoms are 'logical atoms and not physical atoms', he means that they are:

A. the smallest particles recognised by physics B. mental images in the mind of the knower C. the last residue of logical analysis, not microscopic entities D. Kantian noumena beyond all experience

Correct answer: C - the last residue of logical analysis, not microscopic entities

Explanation: 'Atomic' marks logical simplicity and independence reached by analysing propositions, not physical smallness.

MCQ 12

In Russell's atomism, molecular propositions are:

A. names of complex physical objects B. atomic facts in disguise C. incomplete symbols D. truth-functions of atomic propositions, the connectives naming nothing

Correct answer: D - truth-functions of atomic propositions, the connectives naming nothing

Explanation: There is no 'and'-fact in the world; the truth of a molecular proposition is fixed by its atomic parts plus the connectives.

MCQ 13

The isomorphism thesis holds that a true atomic proposition:

A. shares the structure of its fact - names correspond to objects and arrangement to arrangement B. is identical with a mental picture in the speaker C. is a tautology of logic D. denotes a Meinongian subsisting object

Correct answer: A - shares the structure of its fact - names correspond to objects and arrangement to arrangement

Explanation: Russell's bridge between language and world is a structural mirroring of names/objects and their arrangements.

MCQ 14

For Russell, the phrase 'the present King of France' is:

A. a logically proper name B. an incomplete symbol with no meaning in isolation C. a rigid designator D. the name of a universal

Correct answer: B - an incomplete symbol with no meaning in isolation

Explanation: It contributes only inside a whole sentence and disappears when the sentence is analysed into quantifiers.

MCQ 15

On Russell's analysis, 'The present King of France is bald' is:

A. meaningless B. neither true nor false C. false, because the existence clause fails D. true, but only vacuously

Correct answer: C - false, because the existence clause fails

Explanation: Analysed as $(\exists x)[Kx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Ky \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Bx]$, the existence clause is false, so the whole conjunction is false - not meaningless.

MCQ 16

Russell analyses 'the F is G' into which three components?

A. sense, reference and tone B. quality, relation and substance C. subject, copula and predicate D. existence, uniqueness and predication

Correct answer: D - existence, uniqueness and predication

Explanation: There is at least one F, at most one F, and it is G - the trio that dissolves the definite description.

MCQ 17

The apparent conflict over whether 'The King of France is not bald' is true or false is resolved by:

A. the scope distinction - primary (wide) versus secondary (narrow) occurrence of the description B. abandoning the law of excluded middle C. positing a subsisting King of France D. treating 'bald' as hopelessly vague

Correct answer: A - the scope distinction - primary (wide) versus secondary (narrow) occurrence of the description

Explanation: On the narrow-scope reading the negation denies the whole existential claim and is true; no logical law is violated.

MCQ 18

Strawson's objection to Russell's theory of descriptions is that such sentences:

A. are always true B. carry a presupposition of existence, so when it fails the sentence is neither true nor false C. denote Meinongian objects after all D. are disguised tautologies

Correct answer: B - carry a presupposition of existence, so when it fails the sentence is neither true nor false

Explanation: Strawson targets ordinary use; it is a rival account of reference, not a refutation of the logic of Russell's analysis.

MCQ 19

Russell's Principle of Acquaintance states that:

A. all knowledge is ultimately by description B. every object is a logical construction C. every proposition we can understand is composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted D. ordinary names are rigid designators

Correct answer: C - every proposition we can understand is composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted

Explanation: Acquaintance is the foundation on which knowledge by description rests - understanding requires acquaintance with the constituents.

MCQ 20

In Russell's Bismarck example, those of us who never met Bismarck know him:

A. by acquaintance with his very sense-data B. through a logically proper name C. not at all D. purely by description, as 'the first Chancellor of the German Empire'

Correct answer: D - purely by description, as 'the first Chancellor of the German Empire'

Explanation: As the object recedes, knowledge is carried increasingly by description rather than acquaintance.

MCQ 21

For Russell, ordinary proper names such as 'Bismarck' or 'Socrates' are:

A. disguised definite descriptions B. logically proper names guaranteed a referent C. incomplete symbols admitting no analysis D. names of universals

Correct answer: A - disguised definite descriptions

Explanation: Only 'this' and 'that' for present sense-data are logically proper names; ordinary names abbreviate descriptions.

MCQ 22

Russell's 'supreme maxim of scientific philosophising' is:

A. entities must not be multiplied, so all constructions must be denied B. wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities C. the limits of my language are the limits of my world D. whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent

Correct answer: B - wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities

Explanation: The maxim recommends building objects from the known (sense-data) rather than inferring hidden entities we might be wrong about.

MCQ 23

A Russellian 'logical construction' such as a material object is best described as:

A. an inferred entity lying behind the appearances B. a Meinongian subsisting object C. an orderly system of sense-data, expressed by an incomplete symbol D. a physical atom

Correct answer: C - an orderly system of sense-data, expressed by an incomplete symbol

Explanation: Constructions are voiced by incomplete symbols - the same analytic device as definite descriptions.

MCQ 24

The opening ontology of the Tractatus asserts that:

A. the world is the totality of things B. the world is my idea C. the world is the Absolute realising itself D. the world is the totality of facts, not of things

Correct answer: D - the world is the totality of facts, not of things

Explanation: Tractatus 1.1 - the world is facts (objects in combination), not a mere heap of objects.

MCQ 25

According to the picture theory, a proposition:

A. pictures a possible situation, its names going proxy for objects B. is a mental image that resembles its object C. is a tautology of logic D. is the name of a universal

Correct answer: A - pictures a possible situation, its names going proxy for objects

Explanation: Sense is the capacity to depict a possible arrangement; names correspond to objects and arrangement to arrangement.

MCQ 26

'Logical form' in the Tractatus is:

A. unique to spatial pictures B. the pictorial form shared by every picture and by reality, which can be shown but not said C. identical with grammatical form D. a physical property of the ink marks on the page

Correct answer: B - the pictorial form shared by every picture and by reality, which can be shown but not said

Explanation: A picture can depict any pictorial form but not its own logical form; logical form is the universal shared structure.

MCQ 27

A proposition differs from a mere mental image because its picturing relation is:

A. coloured like its object B. spatial in every case C. logical, not psychological D. always true

Correct answer: C - logical, not psychological

Explanation: What a proposition shares with the fact is logical form, not a mental snapshot - which is why translations picture the same situation.

MCQ 28

'Bipolarity' is the requirement that a genuine proposition must:

A. be either a tautology or a contradiction B. name at least one object C. be true in every possible case D. be capable of being true and capable of being false

Correct answer: D - be capable of being true and capable of being false

Explanation: To say something is to rule something out - fixing one place in logical space and excluding the rest.

MCQ 29

In the Tractatus, a tautology is:

A. sinnlos - senseless yet well-formed, saying nothing about the world B. unsinnig - ill-formed nonsense C. false in every possible case D. the general form of the proposition

Correct answer: A - sinnlos - senseless yet well-formed, saying nothing about the world

Explanation: Tautologies and contradictions carry no factual content but are perfectly legitimate; the truths of logic live here.

MCQ 30

The distinction between sinnlos and unsinnig is that:

A. both simply mean 'false' B. sinnlos is well-formed but empty (tautology/contradiction), whereas unsinnig is an ill-formed pseudo-proposition C. sinnlos means nonsense while unsinnig means sense D. they are exact synonyms

Correct answer: B - sinnlos is well-formed but empty (tautology/contradiction), whereas unsinnig is an ill-formed pseudo-proposition

Explanation: Keep the two German terms apart: logic is sinnlos scaffolding; metaphysics stated as fact is unsinnig.

MCQ 31

For the Tractatus, ethics, aesthetics and logical form belong to what can be:

A. said in ordinary factual propositions B. proved by tautology C. shown but not said D. verified by empirical observation

Correct answer: C - shown but not said

Explanation: Value is transcendental - 'there can be no ethical propositions'; such matters are displayed, not stated.

MCQ 32

The 'ladder' metaphor (6.54) implies that the Tractatus's own propositions are:

A. necessary truths of reason B. empirical hypotheses open to test C. tautologies of logic D. nonsense (unsinnig) to be discarded once they have been understood

Correct answer: D - nonsense (unsinnig) to be discarded once they have been understood

Explanation: One climbs the propositions, comes to see the world aright, and then throws the ladder away.

Remedial MCQ 33

REMEDIAL - A frequent ownership error is to treat the 2018 question comparing Berkeley with Moore and Russell as owned by this clause. Correctly, that question is:

A. primary-owned by Empiricism and used here only as a labelled cross-link B. one of the fourteen owned parts of this clause C. a Later Wittgenstein question D. owned by Indian Philosophy

Correct answer: A - primary-owned by Empiricism and used here only as a labelled cross-link

Explanation: Its centre of gravity is Berkeley, so Empiricism owns it; this clause may use its Moore/Russell material but never counts it among the 14.

Remedial MCQ 34

REMEDIAL - What is the correct verdict on Russell's 'The present King of France is bald'?

A. It is meaningless B. It is false, not meaningless C. It is neither true nor false, on Russell's own view D. It is true

Correct answer: B - It is false, not meaningless

Explanation: The common trap is 'meaningless'; Russell's verdict is FALSE. 'Neither true nor false' is Strawson's rival, not Russell's.

Remedial MCQ 35

REMEDIAL - A tautology in the Tractatus should be classified as:

A. false B. unsinnig (nonsense) C. sinnlos (senseless but well-formed) D. part of the mystical

Correct answer: C - sinnlos (senseless but well-formed)

Explanation: Do not call a tautology 'false' or 'nonsense'; it is empty of factual content yet perfectly well-formed.

Remedial MCQ 36

REMEDIAL - Russell's atomism and the Tractatus atomism differ chiefly because:

A. they are in fact identical B. Russell's atoms are Kantian categories C. the Tractatus's atoms are physical particles D. Russell's phase-specific atoms include acquainted particulars and universals, while the Tractatus's objects are logical simples left unexemplified

Correct answer: D - Russell's phase-specific atoms include acquainted particulars and universals, while the Tractatus's objects are logical simples left unexemplified

Explanation: The contrast is epistemic versus logical grounding - a key comparison, not a matter of sameness.

Remedial MCQ 37

REMEDIAL - Moore's 'Refutation of Idealism' establishes precisely that:

A. one argument for idealism (esse est percipi) fails; it does not by itself prove realism or refute Hegel B. realism is thereby directly proved C. Hegel's Absolute Idealism is refuted D. sense-data do not exist

Correct answer: A - one argument for idealism (esse est percipi) fails; it does not by itself prove realism or refute Hegel

Explanation: State the exact limits: the paper refutes one argument for idealism only; overclaiming its reach is the standard error.

Remedial MCQ 38

REMEDIAL - 'The limits of my language mean the limits of my world' (5.6) belongs to:

A. Moore's common-sense realism B. the early Wittgenstein of the Tractatus, where the self is a limit of the world C. Russell's theory of descriptions D. the later Wittgenstein's doctrine of forms of life

Correct answer: B - the early Wittgenstein of the Tractatus, where the self is a limit of the world

Explanation: Keep early and later Wittgenstein separate; this is a Tractatus thesis about the self as a limit, not an object.

Remedial MCQ 39

REMEDIAL - Kripke's later objection to the description theory of names introduces the notion of:

A. the incomplete symbol B. the sense-datum C. the rigid designator D. bipolarity

Correct answer: C - the rigid designator

Explanation: A rigid designator picks out the same object in every possible world, challenging the view that ordinary names are disguised descriptions (a labelled later-provenance point).

Remedial MCQ 40

REMEDIAL - Proposition 7 of the Tractatus reads:

A. 'The world is all that is the case' B. 'Here is one hand' C. 'Esse est percipi' D. 'Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent'

Correct answer: D - 'Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent'

Explanation: Proposition 7; the Pears-McGuinness translation reads 'What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence.'

Supplemental hard MCQs 41-48

These close-distinction questions complete the 48-question coverage floor.

MCQ 41

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Moore's defence of common sense treats ordinary certainties as better known than sceptical premises used against them. B. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first. C. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. D. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words.

Correct answer: A - Moore's defence of common sense treats ordinary certainties as better known than sceptical premises used against them.

Explanation: Moore's defence of common sense treats ordinary certainties as better known than sceptical premises used against them. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 42

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. B. Moore's refutation of idealism distinguishes the object of an experience from the experiencing of it. C. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words. D. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact.

Correct answer: B - Moore's refutation of idealism distinguishes the object of an experience from the experiencing of it.

Explanation: Moore's refutation of idealism distinguishes the object of an experience from the experiencing of it. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 43

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words. B. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact. C. Russell's theory of descriptions analyses definite descriptions contextually rather than treating each as a name. D. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first.

Correct answer: C - Russell's theory of descriptions analyses definite descriptions contextually rather than treating each as a name.

Explanation: Russell's theory of descriptions analyses definite descriptions contextually rather than treating each as a name. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 44

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact. B. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first. C. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. D. A definite description is an incomplete symbol because it has no isolated referent-like meaning outside its propositional use.

Correct answer: D - A definite description is an incomplete symbol because it has no isolated referent-like meaning outside its propositional use.

Explanation: A definite description is an incomplete symbol because it has no isolated referent-like meaning outside its propositional use. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 45

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Logical constructions replace inferred entities with structures built from less problematic data where possible. B. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first. C. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. D. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words.

Correct answer: A - Logical constructions replace inferred entities with structures built from less problematic data where possible.

Explanation: Logical constructions replace inferred entities with structures built from less problematic data where possible. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 46

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. B. Logical atomism analyses the world into facts rather than into a mere inventory of named things. C. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words. D. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact.

Correct answer: B - Logical atomism analyses the world into facts rather than into a mere inventory of named things.

Explanation: Logical atomism analyses the world into facts rather than into a mere inventory of named things. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 47

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. Logical atomism says facts are merely isolated words. B. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact. C. Russell distinguishes knowledge by acquaintance from knowledge by description. D. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first.

Correct answer: C - Russell distinguishes knowledge by acquaintance from knowledge by description.

Explanation: Russell distinguishes knowledge by acquaintance from knowledge by description. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

MCQ 48

Which statement is the most accurate?

A. The Tractatus says logical form is another empirical fact. B. Moore proves common sense by accepting the sceptic's standard first. C. Russell treats every description as a logically proper name. D. Early Wittgenstein treats a proposition as picturing a possible state of affairs through shared logical form.

Correct answer: D - Early Wittgenstein treats a proposition as picturing a possible state of affairs through shared logical form.

Explanation: Early Wittgenstein treats a proposition as picturing a possible state of affairs through shared logical form. The other options reverse or flatten a distinction that is examinable in Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein.

REVIEW-PROMOTED ANALYTIC-TRIO MCQS

MCQ 49

Which ownership statement is correct?

A. "Syng and Showing" is the printed typo for early Wittgenstein's Saying and Showing; verificationism belongs to the next topic. B. Moore owns the verification principle. C. Russell's neutral monism is a printed limb. D. Later private-language arguments belong to early Wittgenstein.

Correct answer: A - The official typo must be preserved only when quoting the syllabus.

MCQ 50

What follows directly from Moore's awareness/object distinction?

A. Every presented object exists unperceived. B. Awareness is not identical with its object, so *esse* cannot simply be defined as *percipi*. C. Scepticism is deductively refuted. D. Hegel's Absolute Idealism is disproved.

Correct answer: B - Mind-independent persistence requires further argument.

MCQ 51

Why did Russell admit negative facts?

A. To make negation a physical object. B. To copy Wittgenstein's ontology. C. To provide truth-making grounds for true negative propositions, despite ontological cost. D. To eliminate all universals.

Correct answer: C - Negative facts are a controversial feature of Russell's atomism.

MCQ 52

How do incomplete symbols relate to logical atomism?

A. They prove that all atoms are sense-data. B. They are meaningless fragments. C. They replace every fact with grammar. D. Contextual elimination removes pseudo-constituents and supports, but does not entail, a final atomist base.

Correct answer: D - The existence and identity of final simples remain separate questions.

MCQ 53

Which distinction between the two atomisms is accurate?

A. Russell combines logical analysis with phase-specific acquaintance commitments; Wittgenstein leaves objects unspecified and characterises them by combinatorial role. B. Both identify atoms with physical particles. C. Wittgenstein accepts Russell's negative facts as logical objects. D. Russell derives atomism from the verification principle.

Correct answer: A - The programmes differ in epistemic grounding and logical architecture.

MCQ 54

If $N(p, q)$ means not- p and not- q , which formula gives p or q ?

A. $N(p, q)$ B. $N(N(p, q))$ C. $N(N(p), N(q))$ D. $N(N(N(p, q)))$

Correct answer: B - Negating the joint negation yields disjunction.

MCQ 55

What is the correct relation between the *Tractatus* and verificationism?

A. Proposition 7 states the verification principle. B. Bipolarity means empirically verified. C. The *Tractatus* supplies picture/sense pressures later transformed by positivists; it does not state their criterion. D. Verificationism and saying/showing are identical.

Correct answer: C - Logical Positivism owns the positive verification theory.

MCQ 56

Which verdict on saying/showing is most precise?

A. Ethics is empirically false. B. The ladder accidentally contradicts the book. C. One uncontested ineffable doctrine follows. D. Standard ineffability and resolute therapeutic readings disagree, while 6.54 makes self-application deliberate.

Correct answer: D - A graded answer states both readings before ruling.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

EXAM APPLICATION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What

How the map itself is examined

- Attribution is not decoration - it is directly tested. Every question in this clause presupposes you can name the **owner**, the **text** and the **year**: Moore's *Refutation of Idealism* (1903), *A Defence of Common Sense* (1925), *Proof of an External World* (1939); Russell's *On Denoting* (1905) and the 1918 atomism lectures; the *Tractatus* (written 1918, published 1921).
- **Comparison directives** ("distinguish", "compare Moore's and Russell's reactions") demand a *criterion first*, then a developmental contrast - never three parallel summaries.
- **Cross-link (labelled, not owned)**: the **2018 Q3(a)** question "How do Moore and Russell react to Berkeley's view...?" is **primary-owned by Empiricism**, because its centre of gravity is Berkeley; use this clause's Moore/Russell material to answer it, but do **not** count it among this clause's 14 owned parts.

10-mark use: name the revolt, the shared method, and the three owners with one text each. **15/20-mark use:** open with the method (analysis of language), then run the specific doctrine the question targets, then close with one precise inter-thinker contrast from the attribution table.

EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2021 Q3(a), 20 marks:** *main arguments in "A Defence of Common Sense" that there are propositions known true with certainty; is Moore's response to the sceptic sufficient?* - the flagship. Give truisms -> knowing vs analysing -> the certainty-comparison (burden reversal) -> then *assess sufficiency* with the question-begging objection and the *On Certainty* diagnosis.
- **2024 Q1(c), 10 marks:** *arguments that there are truisms known by common sense; critically discuss* - the compact version: list truisms, state the knowing/analysing distinction, one line of criticism.
- **2019 Q3(c), 15 marks:** *why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?* - because he treats commonsense truisms as certain knowledge of a mind-independent world and makes philosophy answer to them, not vice versa; add the burden-reversal and the act/object realism of unit 3.

20-mark structure: truisms/list -> knowing vs analysing -> proof of the external world (three conditions) -> burden reversal -> assessment (begs the question? Pryor's reply; *On Certainty* later hinge comparison) -> verdict. **Directive trap:** "critically" and "sufficient response" force *assessment*; narrating "Moore held up his hands" scores poorly.

EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2025 Q3(c), 15 marks:** "*Blue is one object of sensation and green is another...*" - Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement. Quote the sentence verbatim, name the target (*esse est percipi*), draw the **act/object** distinction, add the **diaphanous** thesis, conclude *esse est percipi* is unproven so realism is restored.
- **2020 Q2(b), 15 marks:** "*If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake.*" - *critically discuss*. This is the same argument from the other side: to run together "blue exists" and "blue and consciousness exist" is to identify the object with the act; Moore says the two propositions have *different* content, so the identification is self-contradictory.

15-mark structure: frame (*esse est percipi*) -> act/object distinction -> the quoted sentence -> diaphanous/transparency -> result (awareness and object are non-identical; independence remains to be argued) -> assessment (refutes one argument, not Hegel; diaphanous is the soft spot; sense-datum legacy). **Directive trap:** an "elucidate/critically discuss" quotation question wants the sentence *located in the argument*, not a free-floating gloss.

EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2020 Q2(c), 15 marks:** "*...the atoms... are logical atoms and not physical atoms.*" - write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of this statement. Anchor on the quotation: define atomic facts, stress **logical (not physical)** simplicity/independence, add atomic vs molecular and truth-functionality, and note that "atomic" is the residue of **analysis**.
- **2022 Q1(b), 10 marks:** *what is Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it end in establishing the atomic theory of meaning?* Method = reveal logical form behind grammatical form (descriptions is the exemplar); analysis terminates in simples, so meaning bottoms out in atomic propositions picturing atomic facts.

15-mark structure: quotation -> atomic facts defined (logical, not physical) -> atomic vs molecular + truth-functionality -> isomorphism -> one contrast with the *Tractatus* -> verdict (atomism is the ontology analysis *requires*, and is a conditional whose antecedent later fails). **Directive trap:** never gloss "atomic" as "tiny/physical"; the quotation exists precisely to forbid that.

EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2025 Q1(d), 10 marks:** "*The golden mountain is very high.*" - discuss via Russell's theory of descriptions. Write the three conjuncts (existence, uniqueness, predication), note the existence clause fails so the sentence is **false**, and conclude no golden mountain need "subsist" (contra Meinong); grammatical form $\neq$ logical form.
- **2023 Q4(b), 15 marks:** *why is "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.* State the puzzle (meaningful yet no referent), give the analysis and the three puzzles, then add the **Strawson** presupposition rival as the "critically" component.
- **2024 Q3(a), 20 marks:** *explain incomplete symbols; how this notion leads to logical atomism.* Definition + test (does the phrase disappear on analysis?) -> descriptions as the paradigm -> constructions (unit 7) -> analysis seeks final atoms without proving a unique base (unit 4).

Answer architecture: always **formalise** (the three conjuncts), then scope, then the puzzle solved, then one rival (Strawson) or consequence (ontological economy). **Directive trap:** "discuss via the theory of descriptions" demands the **symbolic analysis**, not a verbal paraphrase; and the sentence is **false**, never "meaningless".

EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **No directly-owned PYQ (2018-2025).** This clause set no standalone acquaintance/description question in the audited window, but the doctrine is **load-bearing** for questions that *are* owned and is a standing high-probability gap - prepare it as a ready 15-marker.
- **Underpins 2018 Q4(c), 15 marks** (*how is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism?*): the point of descriptions is epistemic - **ordinary names are disguised descriptions**, and only logically proper names track acquaintance-objects (the atoms). Bring acquaintance in to explain *why* analysis must terminate in simples.
- **Underpins 2023 Q4(b), 15 marks** (the present King of France): we can understand the sentence though no one is acquainted with its "subject" precisely because the description works **by description**, not by naming an acquaintance-object.
- **If asked directly** (*distinguish acquaintance and description; how are they related?*): two definitions -> acquaintance-objects (sense-data, memory, introspection, universals) -> **Principle of Acquaintance** -> **Bismarck** series (the "how related" hinge) -> logically proper vs ordinary names -> assessment (extends knowledge, but the acquaintance-base is thin).

Directive trap: if a description/atomism question appears, use acquaintance as the *engine*, not as a separate essay; if a direct acquaintance question appears, "how are they related" is the marked part - the Principle of Acquaintance and Bismarck are what score.

EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2018 Q4(c), 15 marks:** *how is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons.* This is the constructions hinge: a definite description is the model **incomplete symbol** (unit 5), the same device generalises into **logical constructions** (material objects, numbers), and analysis of both seeks genuine logical constituents without proving a unique final base (unit 4). Anchor on the **supreme maxim** and Occam's razor, and show the theory of descriptions supplies the *method* that makes atomism reachable.
- **2024 Q3(a), 20 marks (shared):** *incomplete symbols... how this notion leads to logical atomism.* Use constructions as the middle term: incomplete symbols -> constructions replace inferred entities -> analysis seeks final atoms whose existence and identity remain contestable.

20-mark structure: maxim stated -> construction vs inference (table example) -> constructions **are** incomplete symbols (link to unit 5) -> economy/Occam -> continuity with atomism (unit 4) -> critique (solipsism, sense-datum myth, residual inferences) -> verdict (a regulative ideal, method over metaphysics). **Directive trap:** "extension to logical constructions" wants you to **connect** descriptions and constructions, not treat them as two unrelated topics.

EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2022 Q3(c), 15 marks:** *explain the picture theory of meaning of the early Wittgenstein.* Spine: ontology first (world = facts, states of affairs, objects) -> proposition as **picture** -> names/objects + shared **structure** -> **pictorial vs logical form** -> truth/falsity by agreement -> "not a mental image" -> close with the limit that form can only be *shown* (bridge to saying/showing).
- **Conceptual link (not a separate PYQ):** picture theory is the *Tractatus* radicalisation of Russell's isomorphism (unit 4); if an atomism/analysis question turns to Wittgenstein, use picturing to explain how elementary propositions get their sense by depicting states of affairs.

15-mark structure: 1.1 quotation -> objects/states of affairs/elementary propositions -> the picturing relation -> the three forms (esp. logical form) -> possibility of truth/falsity -> disclaimer (logical, not mental) -> one-line bridge to showing. **Directive trap:** don't psychologise "picture" (no mental images) and don't skip the **ontology** - picture theory is unintelligible without the thesis "facts, not things".

EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **Feeds 2021 Q4(c), 15 marks** (saying/showing, unit 10): the *sinnlos/unsinnig* split and the limits of sense are the machinery behind "what can only be shown." Bring the general form + tautology material as the technical underpinning.
- **Standard technical prompt:** "the limits of meaningful (factual) discourse in the *Tractatus*" - answer with bipolarity
-> logical space -> the middle zone alone pictures -> tautology/contradiction as *sinnlos* -> metaphysics as *unsinnig*
-> "whereof one cannot speak..." (unit 10).

15-mark structure: bipolarity defined -> logical space -> general form $[p\text{-bar}, xi\text{-bar}, N(xi\text{-bar})]$ and reduction of connectives to N -> the three zones -> *sinnlos* vs *unsinnig* (tabled) -> consequence for logic and metaphysics -> bridge to showing. **Directive trap:** never call a tautology "**false**" or "**nonsense**" - it is **senseless** (*sinnlos*) yet well-formed; reserve *unsinnig* for ill-formed pseudo-propositions.

EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2018 Q3(c), 15 marks:** how does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between "saying" and "showing" to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Define the pair -> the "showing" inventory (logical form, ethics/aesthetics, the mystical, the self) -> the "single way": the decisive problems are not solved but **dissolved** as attempts to say what can only be *shown* -> then answer "is he justified?" through the self-referential paradox and a chosen verdict (resolute vs standard).
- **2021 Q4(c), 15 marks:** what does Wittgenstein mean by "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss. Gloss **proposition 7** -> what falls on the "silent" side (ethics, the mystical, logical form) -> the **ladder (6.54)** -> "critically": the paradox that the *Tractatus*'s own sentences are *unsinnig* -> verdict. Note this is early Wittgenstein; the *transition* to the later view is a boundary, not the topic.

15-mark structure: the distinction -> the "showing" inventory -> 6.54 ladder + prop 7 -> the paradox (nonsense yet instructive) -> verdict. **Provenance discipline:** quote prop 7 and label it as such; use the decimal numbering; if giving German, note the translation (Ogden vs Pears-McGuinness). Do **not** import *Philosophical Investigations* doctrine here except to mark the boundary. **Directive trap:** "discuss its implications" = go past the definition to ethics/mystical + the ladder/paradox; a bare gloss caps the mark.

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Western Philosophy Paper I bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 14 clause-owned questions, at least one in every year (joint-highest in the Western section).
- The 2018 Q3(a) Berkeley/Moore/Russell comparison is primary-owned by Empiricism; it is used only as a labelled cross-link and never counted among the 14. Later Wittgenstein parts (private language, family resemblance, use-theory, forms of life) are owned by the Later Wittgenstein clause and kept separate.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: claim -> named text/quotation -> analysis -> objection/reply -> verdict.
- MCQs: 32 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 40, strict A-B-C-D rotation ten times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Contemporary linkage is not forced: no verified 2026 news anchor exists, so none is invented; the standing relevance is the clause's permanent place in the philosophy of language.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is exact verified PYQs -> 32 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED TEXT/EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION/REPLY -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 14 VERIFIED CLAUSE-OWNED QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Western Philosophy Paper I bank for 2018-2025. Moore-Russell-Early Wittgenstein owns exactly 14 primary parts (joint-highest), at least one in every year. The 2018 Q3(a) Berkeley/Moore/Russell comparison is primary-owned by Empiricism and is used only as a labelled cross-link, never counted here. Later Wittgenstein parts (private language, family resemblance, use-theory, forms of life) are kept strictly separate even when they discuss the transition from the Tractatus.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "how does he apply... is he justified?": expound the application, then deliver a reasoned verdict.

Thesis. The saying/showing distinction gives Wittgenstein a *single* meta-philosophical method: the "most decisive problems" of philosophy are not solved but **dissolved**, because they are attempts to *say* what can only be *shown*. He is largely justified as diagnosis, though the method is self-undermining.

The distinction. To say is to assert a senseful factual proposition that pictures a contingent state of affairs (bipolar - capable of truth *and* falsity). What can only be *shown* includes the **logical form** language shares with the world, and the **ethical, aesthetic and mystical**.

The single way. Metaphysics, the self, the meaning of life and value all try to state what lies outside the picturable world; each is therefore *unsinnig* (nonsense), not false. The one correct method is, for every such problem, to exhibit that its sentences transgress the limits of sense - so the problem lapses. Logic, ethics and metaphysics are handled by one criterion.

Named text. Proposition 7: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent." The ladder (6.54): the Tractatus's own propositions are nonsense to be climbed and then thrown away.

Is he justified? (reasons).

- *For*: the distinction unifies logic and value under a single account of sense, genuinely deflates pseudo-problems, and influences later anti-metaphysical programmes without stating verificationism.
- *Against*: the **self-referential paradox** - if the Tractatus is nonsense, how does it instruct? Russell objected that Wittgenstein "manages to say a good deal about what cannot be said." The **resolute** reading treats the sentences as therapeutic nonsense; the **standard** reading as illuminating nonsense that gestures at what shows itself. The underlying picture theory also faces the colour-exclusion problem.

Verdict. Justified as a diagnostic that relocates the decisive problems to the domain of showing; only partly justified as doctrine, since its self-application is paradoxical and is better read as *marking* the boundary than stating a further truth.

Why this earns marks: It derives saying/showing from picture theory, distinguishes factual saying from logical manifestation, and evaluates the ladder without reducing value-discourse to falsehood.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: How is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "how related... discuss and give reasons": exhibit the internal link, not two separate topics.

Thesis. The theory of definite descriptions is the **engine** of Logical Atomism: it shows how apparent referring expressions dissolve into quantificational structure, which licenses analysis down to genuine simples - the atoms.

Descriptions (the method). "The F is G" analyses as $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$. "The present King of France is bald" is therefore **false, not meaningless**; "the F" is an **incomplete symbol** with no meaning in isolation that *disappears* on analysis.

Three links to atomism.

1. **Grammatical vs logical form.** Descriptions prove that surface grammar hides logical form; atomism is the thesis that this analysis *terminates* in atomic propositions picturing atomic facts.
2. **Incomplete symbols -> constructions.** The same device dissolves classes, numbers and material objects into **logical constructions**: "Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities." What survives analysis are atoms (logically proper names) and universals.
3. **Ontological economy.** Descriptions banish Meinong's non-existent objects; atomism keeps only what analysis certifies. **Isomorphism** then pairs each atomic proposition with an atomic fact.

Named text. "On Denoting" (1905); the atoms are "logical atoms and not physical atoms" - the *last residue in analysis*, of which descriptions is the exemplar.

Objection/reply. Strawson (1950) charges that descriptions misdescribe ordinary use (presupposition, not assertion). Reply: even granting this about conversation, the *analytical* discovery - that meaning has hidden logical structure terminating in simples - is exactly what atomism needs.

Verdict. Descriptions supply the paradigm of analysis that atomism generalises; the two are one programme - method (descriptions) and its metaphysical terminus (atoms).

Why this earns marks: It connects descriptions to atomism through elimination of apparent constituents, uses existence-uniqueness-predication and qualifies the claimed route to simples.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?

Model solution

Directive - "why is it called...": justify the label on both counts, common sense *and* realism.

Thesis. Moore's philosophy is "common-sense realism" because he holds that certain commonsense **truisms** about a **mind-independent** world are known with certainty, and that philosophy must answer to them rather than overturn them.

The "common-sense" half. In "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore lists **truisms** - I have a body, the earth existed for many years before my birth, there are other people - each "known to be true with certainty." Crucially, **knowing is not analysing**: we know a truism is true even when we cannot give its correct analysis (the paradox of analysis). Certainty attaches to the truism, not to any philosopher's theory of it.

The "realism" half. The world these truisms describe is **mind-independent**. This is reinforced by the **Refutation of Idealism** (act/object distinction defeats *esse est percipi*) and the **Proof of an External World** (1939): "Here is one hand... and here is another" is offered as a rigorous proof that external things exist.

Method / burden reversal. Philosophy defends common sense; when a sceptical or idealist argument conflicts with a truism, its premises are *less* certain than "here is one hand," so it is the argument that must be rejected.

Objection/reply. The sceptic charges question-begging. Reply: Moore reverses the **burden of proof** rather than refuting doubt head-on; Later *On Certainty* reframes the role of hinge-like certainties; this is comparison, not owner content.

Verdict. "Common-sense realism" is apt: it names Moore's **epistemology** (commonsense certainties) and his **ontology** (mind-independent realism) together, even if its anti-sceptical force remains contested.

Why this earns marks: It defines Moorean common-sense realism through truisms, knowing-versus-analysis and comparative certainty rather than merely repeating the hands gesture.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Critically discuss the following statement by Moore: "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake."

Model solution

Directive - "critically discuss": expound the point, then weigh it.

Thesis. The remark distils Moore's **Refutation of Idealism**: to identify "Blue exists" with "Both blue and consciousness exist" is to conflate the **object** of awareness with the **act** of awareness, and that identification is self-contradictory because the two propositions have different content.

Context. The target is Berkeley's *esse est percipi*. Idealism treats a sensation as an undifferentiated unity; Moore analyses every sensation into two elements - the **act** (consciousness, the *same* in the sensation of blue and of green) and the **object** (the blue, the green, which *differ*).

The quoted claim. "Blue exists" asserts the object; "blue and consciousness exist" asserts object *plus* act. To call these the *same* proposition is to smuggle consciousness into the very content of "blue." Since they plainly assert different things, the identification is a "self-contradictory mistake."

Diaphanous thesis. Consciousness is **transparent** - we look straight through it to the blue and overlook the act; that transparency is *why* the idealist fuses object with act and arrives at *esse est percipi*.

Result. Object $\neq$ act; the object can therefore exist unperceived; *esse* $\neq$ *percipi*.

Critical assessment.

- The **diaphanous** thesis is also Moore's soft spot: if awareness is never directly caught, the act/object distinction is *asserted* rather than *exhibited*.
- **Limits:** the argument refutes *one* argument for idealism, not realism directly, and does **not** touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism.

- The **sense-datum** legacy (object as a given item) later collapses under Sellars' "Myth of the Given."

Verdict. Moore's charge of self-contradiction lands squarely on the *identification*; the negative result is secure even though the positive sense-datum doctrine it inspired proved unstable.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs the blue-consciousness distinction, explains transparency and limits the conclusion to the failure of an identity-based idealist argument.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: "The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of the above statement.

Model solution

Directive - "write a note... in the light of the statement": anchor everything on the quotation.

Thesis. For Russell, atomic facts are the simplest constituents of reality; they are **logical** atoms - the last residue of **analysis** - and emphatically **not physical** atoms.

The quotation. "The atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." So "atomic" marks **logical simplicity and independence**, reached by analysing propositions, not microscopic size discovered by physics.

Nature of atomic facts.

- An **atomic fact** is a simple particular having a quality or standing in a relation - e.g., "this is red." It is what corresponds to a true **atomic proposition** (a logically proper name, or names, plus a predicate).
- **Atomic vs molecular:** molecular propositions ("p and q," "p or q") are **truth-functions** of atomic ones; the connectives name nothing - there is no "and"-fact in the world.
- **Isomorphism:** a true atomic proposition shares the structure of its fact - names correspond to objects, and the *arrangement* of names to the *arrangement* of objects.

Logical, not physical (developed). The atoms are Russell's **sense-data and universals**, identified by acquaintance - an **epistemological** base. This contrasts with the *Tractatus*'s "objects," which are logical simples whose nature is left unspecified.

Objection/reply. The sense-datum base is empirically vulnerable (Sellars). Reply: whatever the ultimate simples turn out to be, the *logical* point stands - meaning and truth bottom out in atomic propositions picturing atomic facts.

Verdict. Atomic facts are the ontological correlates that analysis *requires*; the quoted sentence exists precisely to forbid mistaking them for tiny physical particles.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes logical from physical atoms, relates atomic facts to atomic propositions and qualifies the independence and final-analysis claims.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: What are the main arguments put forward by Moore in his paper "A Defence of Common Sense" to prove that there are possible propositions about the world that are known to be true with certainty? Do you think Moore's arguments provide a sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic against the possibility of knowledge? Give reasons in support of your answer.

Model solution

Directive - "what are the arguments... do you think they are sufficient?": expound, then judge against the sceptic.

Thesis. In "A Defence of Common Sense," Moore argues that a class of commonsense **truisms** is known to be true with certainty; his answer to scepticism is a **burden-reversal** that is dialectically compelling but, against the radical sceptic, not demonstratively sufficient.

Moore's arguments.

1. **The list of truisms** (1925): "I have a body," "the earth existed for years before my birth," "there are other human beings" - each known *with certainty*.
2. **Knowing vs analysing:** we *know* these are true even though we cannot state their correct **analysis** (the paradox of analysis); certainty does not wait on analysis.
3. **Self-refutation of the sceptic:** the philosopher who asserts "there are no other people" presupposes an audience and a shared language.
4. **Certainty comparison / burden reversal:** no premise of a sceptical argument is *more* certain than "here is one hand." Developed in the **Proof of an External World** (1939): "Here is one hand... and here is another" is a proof whose premises are known, differ from the conclusion, and entail it (Moore's three conditions).

Is it sufficient? (reasons on both sides).

- *For:* it relocates certainty to where it actually lies and shifts the **burden** onto the sceptic; Later *On Certainty* offers a different hinge-based diagnosis of the strategy - the truisms are **hinges** on which doubt turns and thereby reframes what counts as doubt.
- *Against:* Moore never *proves* he is not dreaming; against a sceptic who challenges the very **entitlement** to the premises, "here is one hand" **begs the question**; the proof assumes what is at issue.

Verdict. Against the *dogmatic* sceptic Moore's burden-reversal is sufficient and is deepened by the later hinge comparison; against the *radical* sceptic it is a powerful dialectical stance rather than a demonstrative refutation.

Why this earns marks: It presents Moore's qualified truism list, answers the sceptic's dialectical objection and distinguishes a valid proof from a complete theory of knowledge.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement - "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what does he mean... critically discuss": gloss proposition 7, then weigh it.

Thesis. Proposition 7 draws the **limit of language from within**: only factual, picturing propositions can be *said*; logical form, ethics, aesthetics and the mystical can at most be *shown*, so of them "one must be silent."

Meaning in context. The Tractatus fixes the limits of sense through **bipolarity** (a genuine proposition must be able to be true *and* false). Two limiting cases carry no factual content - tautology and contradiction are **sinnlos** (senseless but well-formed); attempts to state what lies beyond the picturable world are **unsinnig** (nonsense).

What falls on the silent side.

- **Logical form** - shown by propositions, never stated by them.
- **Ethics and aesthetics** - transcendental; "there can be no ethical propositions."
- **The mystical** - "not *how* the world is... but *that* it is."
- **The metaphysical self** - a limit of the world, not an object in it.

Named text. Proposition 7 - Ogden: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent"; Pears-McGuinness: "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence." Ladder (6.54): the Tractatus's own sentences are nonsense to be discarded once they have done their work.

Critical assessment. The doctrine is a precise consequence of the picture theory, not mysticism-for-its-own-sake. But it faces the **self-referential paradox**: if 7 itself cannot be said, the book saws off the branch it sits on. Readings diverge - **resolute** (plain therapeutic nonsense) vs **standard** (illuminating nonsense); Russell worried Wittgenstein says much about the unsayable.

Verdict. Proposition 7 is the disciplined terminus of the picture theory; its paradox is genuine and is best read as *marking* the boundary of sense rather than asserting a further fact beyond it.

Why this earns marks: It reads proposition 7 through saying/showing and 6.54, adds the self-referential objection and reaches a graded verdict on elucidatory nonsense.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2022 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: What is Bertrand Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it ultimately end in establishing atomic theory of meaning? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what is the method... how does it end in atomic theory of meaning": connect method to terminus.

Thesis. Russell's method of **logical analysis** replaces misleading grammatical form with real logical form; pursued to its end, analysis terminates in **atomic propositions** whose meaning is their picturing of **atomic facts** - an atomic theory of meaning.

The method. Surface grammar deceives: "the present King of France" *looks* like a name but is an **incomplete symbol**. Analysis (the **theory of descriptions** is the exemplar) rewrites such sentences to expose their quantificational logical form, and **logical constructions** replace inferred entities ("substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities").

How it ends in atomism. Each analysis removes an apparent constituent until nothing further can be decomposed. What remains are **simples** - logically proper names for acquaintance-objects (sense-data) plus universals. Meaning bottoms out exactly here: an **atomic proposition** means the **atomic fact** it pictures (isomorphism of names/objects and arrangement/arrangement), and every molecular proposition is a **truth-function** of atomic ones.

Named text. The atoms are "logical atoms and not physical atoms" - the last residue of analysis.

Assessment. The acquaintance base is contestable (Sellars), but the structural claim is robust: analysis fixes meaning by grounding it in the simplest picturing propositions.

Verdict. Analysis is the method and atomism its terminus; the theory of meaning is atomic because significance is anchored in atomic propositions depicting atomic facts.

Why this earns marks: It moves from grammatical to logical form, explains facts and atomic propositions and shows why analysis is methodological rather than physical decomposition.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2022 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.

Model solution

Directive - "is there any difference... how does logical form relate language and reality": distinguish the two forms, then use logical form as the bridge.

Thesis. Yes - **pictorial form** is what lets a picture depict *at all*, whereas **logical form** is the form shared by *every* picture and by reality; logical form is precisely the shared structure that connects language to the world.

Ontology first. "The world is the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1); states of affairs are **objects** in combination. A proposition is a **picture** of a possible situation: names go proxy for objects, and the **arrangement** of names mirrors the arrangement of objects.

Pictorial form. The possibility that the picture's elements are combined as the things are. It varies with the medium - a spatial picture has spatial form, a coloured one colour form, a musical score its own form.

Logical form. The **pictorial form common to all pictures whatever** - the form a picture and reality *must* share to be able to depict truly or falsely. A picture can depict any pictorial form, but it **cannot depict its own logical form**: logical form is **shown, not said**.

The difference. Pictorial form is the species (medium-specific); logical form is the universal genus - the minimal structure any representation must share with what it represents.

How logical form relates language and reality. A proposition connects to the world by **sharing logical form** with the fact it represents; because it pictures a mere *possibility*, it can **agree or disagree** with reality - truth or falsity, hence **bipolarity**. This picturing is **logical, not psychological**: a proposition is not a mental image.

Verdict. There is a real difference - species vs the universal genus - and it is **logical form**, the isomorphism between sentence and fact, that makes representation and therefore the whole language-world relation possible.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes pictorial from logical form, maps names to objects and explains why representation requires shared possibility rather than visual resemblance.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q4(b), 15 marks

Question: Why according to Russell is the proposition - "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "why problematic... critically discuss": state the puzzle, give the analysis, then weigh a rival.

Thesis. The sentence is problematic because it is **meaningful yet lacks a referent**; Russell dissolves the problem by analysing the description into **existence + uniqueness + predication**, which makes the sentence **false, not meaningless**, with no dubious object.

The puzzle. Grammatically "The present King of France is bald" is subject-predicate, so it *seems* to require a King to be *about*; yet there is none. Rivals pay a price: **Meinong** posits a subsisting non-existent King (ontological extravagance); on a Fregean line the sentence lacks a truth-value.

Russell's analysis. $(\exists x)[Kx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Ky \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Bx]$ - "there is exactly one present King of France and he is bald." The **existence** clause is false, so the whole conjunction is **FALSE**. "The present King of France" is an **incomplete symbol**: no meaning in isolation, it *disappears* on analysis, so nothing need be denoted.

Payoff - three puzzles solved. Negative existentials ("the KoF does not exist" is coherent); **excluded middle** via **scope** (on the *secondary/narrow* occurrence "it is not the case that there is exactly one bald KoF" is **true**); identity/substitutivity (the description is quantificational, not referential).

Critical - the rival. Strawson ("On Referring," 1950): the sentence is **neither true nor false**; *using* "the present King of France" carries a **presupposition** of existence that here fails, so the question of truth-value does not arise. This is a genuine rival about *ordinary language*, but it does not overturn the *logic* of Russell's analysis, which was never a theory of conversation.

Verdict. Russell makes the sentence false and referent-free without Meinongian objects; the enduring lesson is **grammatical form $\neq$ logical form**, though Strawson's presupposition account remains a live alternative about ordinary use.

Why this earns marks: It stages the King-of-France analysis, explains why existence failure makes the conjunction false and includes Strawson's presupposition challenge.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms, knowledge of which is a matter of common sense? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive - "what arguments... critically discuss": list the arguments, then weigh them.

Thesis. Moore argues that a set of **truisms** is known to be true with certainty **as a matter of common sense**, and that their certainty outweighs any philosophical premise brought against them.

The arguments.

1. **The truisms themselves** ("A Defence of Common Sense," 1925): "I have a body," "the earth existed for many years," "there are other people" - each "known to be true with certainty."
2. **Knowing vs analysing:** we *know* a truism even when we cannot give its correct **analysis**; certainty does not depend on solving the paradox of analysis.
3. **Self-refutation of denial:** to assert "there are no other people" is pragmatically self-defeating, presupposing an audience and language.
4. **Burden reversal:** no premise of a sceptical argument is *more* certain than the truism it would deny.

Critical assessment. The sceptic replies that Moore **begs the question** - he relocates certainty rather than defeating radical doubt. Yet Later *On Certainty* reframes Moore: the truisms function as **hinges** on which the practice of doubt itself turns, so they are not the sort of thing that *can* be doubted.

Verdict. Moore secures the truisms **dialectically** by burden-reversal; the case is compelling against dogmatic scepticism and, via the later hinge comparison, resilient - though against the radical sceptic it persuades rather than demonstrates.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs Moore's truisms and certainty comparison, then tests whether common sense supplies an argument or only an epistemic starting point.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain Russell's notion of incomplete symbols. Also explain how this notion leads to the doctrine of logical atomism.

Model solution

Directive - "explain... also explain how it leads to atomism": define, then trace the road to atomism.

Thesis. An **incomplete symbol** has no meaning in isolation and *disappears* on analysis; generalising this device - descriptions, then constructions - drives analysis down to genuine simples, and that terminus is **Logical Atomism**.

Incomplete symbols defined. A symbol that means nothing on its own and contributes only in the context of a whole proposition; the **test** is that it vanishes when the sentence is rewritten. The paradigm is the **definite description** ("On Denoting," 1905): $(Ex)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Gx]$. "The present King of France is bald" is thus **false, not meaningless**, and posits no Meinongian object.

Generalisation to constructions. Classes, numbers and material objects are likewise incomplete symbols / **logical constructions**: "Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities" (the supreme maxim; Occam's razor). A material object becomes an orderly **system of sense-data**, not an inferred hidden thing.

The road to atomism. Each analysis removes an apparent entity; the process terminates in **atomic propositions** - logically proper names for acquaintance-objects plus universals - that **picture atomic facts**. "The atoms... are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Isomorphism pairs atomic proposition with atomic fact; molecular propositions are **truth-functions**.

Assessment. The sense-datum base is vulnerable (Sellars); private data raise the **solipsism/other-minds** worry; Strawson contests the descriptions analysis; some inferences resist construction, so the maxim is a **regulative ideal**. Even so, the structural thesis - meaning and ontology bottom out in analysed simples - is exactly atomism.

Verdict. Incomplete symbols are the analytic **lever**; applied across the board they yield the sparse, structured world of logical atomism - a metaphysics generated by a method.

Why this earns marks: It defines incomplete symbols contextually, connects descriptions and constructions to atomism and evaluates whether analysis really reaches independent simples.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions.

Model solution

Directive - "discuss this statement in the context of the theory of descriptions": apply the analysis to the example.

Thesis. "The golden mountain is very high" is handled by the **theory of descriptions**: analysed into **existence + uniqueness + predication**, its existence clause fails, so the sentence is **false** - and no golden mountain need "subsist."

The problem. The phrase "the golden mountain" denotes nothing, yet the sentence is perfectly meaningful. **Meinong** would grant the golden mountain a shadowy "being"; Russell rejects such ontological extravagance.

The analysis. $(\exists x)[(Gx \ \& \ Mx) \ \& \ (\forall y)((Gy \ \& \ My) \rightarrow y=x) \ \& \ Hx]$ - "there is exactly one thing that is golden and a mountain, and it is very high." Because **nothing** is both golden and a mountain, the **existence** clause is false, so the whole sentence is **FALSE**. "The golden mountain" is an **incomplete symbol**: no meaning in isolation, it *disappears* on analysis, carrying **no** ontological commitment.

Payoff. The example shows **grammatical form $\neq$ logical form** and secures **ontological economy** - significance without Meinongian objects.

Verdict. The sentence is significant but **false**; the theory of descriptions dissolves the pseudo-entity, exhibiting Russell's analytic method in miniature.

Why this earns marks: It eliminates the golden mountain through quantificational form, avoids Meinongian commitment and keeps falsehood distinct from meaninglessness.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement.

Model solution

Directive - "present an account... with reference to this statement": keep the quoted sentence at the centre.

Thesis. The quoted sentence is the crux of Moore's **Refutation of Idealism**: by distinguishing the **object** of sensation (blue, green) from the **consciousness** common to both, Moore separates what idealism runs together and so refutes *esse est percipi*.

Target. Berkeley's *esse est percipi* and, generally, idealism's claim that reality is mind-dependent.

The argument. Every sensation has two elements: the **act** (consciousness, the *same* in the sensation of blue and of green) and the **object** (the blue, the green, which *differ*). The quoted sentence states exactly this: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either."

Diaphanous thesis. Consciousness is **transparent** - we look straight through it to the blue and overlook the act. That transparency explains *why* the idealist fuses object with act and concludes *esse est percipi*.

Result. Object $\neq$ act; therefore the object can exist **unperceived**; *esse $\neq$ percipi*.

Critical assessment. The **diaphanous** thesis is also the weak point: if awareness is never caught directly, the act/object distinction is *asserted* rather than *exhibited*. **Limits:** the argument refutes *one* argument for idealism, not realism directly, and does **not** touch Hegel's Absolute Idealism; the **sense-datum** legacy later collapses under

Sellars.

Verdict. With reference to this statement, Moore's separation of object from act defeats *esse est percipi*; the negative refutation succeeds even though the positive sense-datum theory it inspired does not.

Why this earns marks: It uses the exact blue-green-consciousness contrast, explains diaphanous awareness and states why Moore's target is narrower than all idealism.

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain Moore's 'paradox of analysis'. Why does it not undermine his defence of common sense? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The paradox of analysis is that a correct conceptual analysis appears *either* trivial *or* false; Moore defuses it by separating **knowing** a proposition from **analysing** it.

The paradox. Analyse "brother" as "male sibling." If analysans and analysandum have the *same* meaning, the analysis is a trivial identity ("a brother is a brother"); if it says something *new*, it seems *incorrect*. So a correct analysis looks uninformative, an informative one looks wrong.

Why common sense is safe. Moore demands correct analyses of common-sense concepts yet concedes we may not find them. But **knowing** $\neq$ **analysing**: we know truisms ("here is a hand") are true *with certainty* even when their correct analysis eludes us. Analysis works at the level of *concepts*; knowledge at the level of *truth*.

Verdict. The paradox shows analysis is not trivial word-swapping, but its sceptical bite is blocked - certainty rests on knowing, not on completed analysis.

Why this earns marks: The answer distinguishes proof from sceptical persuasion, gives Moore's conditions and states why certainty comparison remains philosophically significant.

Original Mains 2 - 15 marks

Question: Assess the claim that the early Wittgenstein's picture theory is a radicalisation of Russell's isomorphism thesis rather than a mere restatement of it. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The picture theory *inherits* Russell's isomorphism but **radicalises** it: it keeps the structural mirroring of language and world while making it the essence of *all* sense and pushing it to a limit where form can only be **shown**.

The shared core. For Russell, a true atomic proposition shares the structure of its atomic fact - names correspond to objects, arrangement to arrangement. Wittgenstein retains exactly this: a proposition is a **picture**, names go proxy for objects, and arrangement mirrors arrangement.

Three radicalisations.

1. **Generality.** Russell's isomorphism holds of *atomic* propositions; Wittgenstein makes picturing the **general form of the proposition** - every proposition is a truth-function of elementary ones, $[p\text{-bar}, xi\text{-bar}, N(xi\text{-bar})]$.
2. **Ground.** Russell's atoms are **sense-data and universals**, known by acquaintance (epistemic); Wittgenstein's "objects" are logical simples whose nature is left unspecified - the ground shifts from **epistemology to logic**.
3. **Showing.** Wittgenstein draws the consequence Russell did not: a proposition cannot depict its own **logical form**; form is **shown, not said** - yielding saying/showing and proposition 7.

Assessment. The continuity is genuine (Russell's own Introduction acknowledges it), but the differences are decisive; and the radicalised theory exposes a new fault line - the **colour-exclusion problem** (elementary propositions are not logically independent).

Verdict. "Radicalisation," not "restatement": Wittgenstein universalises isomorphism, relocates its ground to logic, and converts its unstatable residue into the doctrine of showing.

Why this earns marks: The answer relates grammatical form, acquaintance, description, construction and incomplete symbols without treating them as interchangeable labels.

Original Mains 3 - 20 marks

Question: 'The analytic movement replaced metaphysics with the logical analysis of language.' Critically examine this claim with reference to Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein. Answer in about 300 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The slogan captures a real methodological revolution but **overstates** it: the three thinkers replaced *speculative system-building* with the analysis of language, yet each retained a substantive **metaphysics** that analysis was meant to *reveal*, not abolish.

The revolt and its method. Against Bradley's Absolute Idealism, Moore and Russell (then Wittgenstein) made **logical analysis** - exposing logical form behind grammatical form - the central task of philosophy.

Evidence for the slogan.

- Russell's **theory of descriptions** dissolves apparent commitments ("the present King of France," "the golden mountain"): grammatical form misleads, and Meinong's jungle is cleared by logic.
- **Logical constructions** replace inferred entities - "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities."
- Wittgenstein's **saying/showing** consigns metaphysics and ethics to the unsayable; the Tractatus is a **ladder** to be discarded (prop 7).

Evidence against (metaphysics retained).

- **Logical Atomism** is itself a metaphysics - the world is a totality of **atomic facts**; analysis *reveals* ontology, it does not merely dissolve it.
- The Tractatus *opens* with ontology: "the world is the totality of facts, not of things"; objects, states of affairs. Picturing presupposes a metaphysical structure.
- **Moore** defends a robustly **realist** metaphysics (mind-independent objects) via common sense - vindicating, not abolishing, metaphysics.

Critical balance. The movement replaced one *method* (a priori system-building) with another (analysis) and disciplined ontology by logic; but "replaced metaphysics" is too strong. Later analytic philosophy confirms the point - Strawson's descriptive metaphysics and Kripke's rigid designators revive de re necessity within the analytic method.

Verdict. Analysis of language displaced *speculative* metaphysics as the method; it did not eliminate metaphysics. Each thinker grounds his analysis in a metaphysical picture - so the movement **transformed** rather than abolished metaphysics.

Why this earns marks: The answer compares all three programmes, reconstructs one central argument from each and reaches a qualified verdict on analysis as anti-metaphysical method.

Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades

Use these after the detailed models; they do not replace the models.

EXAM APPLICATION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 1 - The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis) - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms) - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names) - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences) - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7 - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

Workbook Source Audit - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **Workbook Source Audit**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

Practice Design - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **Practice Design**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 14 VERIFIED CLAUSE-OWNED QUESTIONS - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 14 VERIFIED CLAUSE-OWNED QUESTIONS**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS - timed-paper upgrade

How to improve this answer: For the demand **ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

Executable compression plan: 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.